

Design System – Runtime Palette

Revision: 1 Last modified: 2026-06-06T00:00:00Z

The dashboard, admin surfaces, and every embedded app share a single runtime-switchable colour system. Palettes are applied to `document.documentElement` as CSS custom properties by `ThemeService`, so every bit of UI that reads `var(--color-*)` picks up the change instantly.

Why Darcula + #9d001e?

The default palette is **Darcula** (the JetBrains IDE greys) paired with a blood-red accent extracted directly from `assets/Logo.jpeg` – the qBittorrent logo. The accent is `#9d001e`. A warm gold contrast (`#d9a441`) is the secondary accent for badges and freeleech pills. This pairing keeps the UI distinctly on-brand while staying neutral enough to remain readable under long sessions.

Catalogue

Eight palettes ship out of the box. Every palette supplies a **dark** and a **light** variant. Sources are linked next to each palette name.

Darcula

JetBrains Darcula greys – paired with the qBittorrent logo’s blood-red. Source: <https://colorshexa.com/palette/darcula-palette>

Token	Dark	Light
bgPrimary	#2b2b2b	#ffffff
bgSecondary	#3c3f41	#f2f2f2
bgTertiary	#4e5254	#e4e4e4
border	#555555	#c9c9c9
textPrimary	#a9b7c6	#1c1c1c
textSecondary	#808080	#555555
accent	#9d001e	#9d001e
accentHover	#c4002a	#7d0017
contrast	#d9a441	#b07d1f
success	#6a8759	#0a7b28
danger	#cc7832	#c9302c
warning	#d9a441	#b07d1f
info	#6897bb	#1e6fa8
purple	#9876aa	#6f42c1
shadow	rgba(0,0,0,0.55)	rgba(0,0,0,0.12)

Dracula

Source: <https://draculatheme.com/contribute>

Token	Dark	Light
bgPrimary	#282a36	#f8f8f2
bgSecondary	#343746	#eeeeec
bgTertiary	#44475a	#e0e0da
border	#6272a4	#c9c9c0
textPrimary	#f8f8f2	#282a36
textSecondary	#bfbfbf	#6272a4
accent	#ff79c6	#d6336c
accentHover	#ff92d0	#bd255a
contrast	#bd93f9	#7048e8
success	#50fa7b	#2b8a3e
danger	#ff5555	#c92a2a
warning	#f1fa8c	#b08900
info	#8be9fd	#1c7ed6
purple	#bd93f9	#6741d9
shadow	rgba(0,0,0,0.55) rgba(0,0,0,0.12)	

Solarized

Ethan Schoonover's Solarized "precision colours for machines and people. Source: <https://colorshexa.com/palette/solarized-palette>

Token	Dark	Light
bgPrimary	#002b36	#fdf6e3
bgSecondary	#073642	#eee8d5
bgTertiary	#0a4453	#d9d2bf
border	#586e75	#93a1a1
textPrimary	#93a1a1	#073642
textSecondary	#657b83	#657b83
accent	#268bd2	#268bd2
accentHover	#2aa198	#1d70ad
contrast	#b58900	#b58900
success	#859900	#859900
danger	#dc322f	#dc322f
warning	#b58900	#b58900
info	#268bd2	#268bd2
purple	#6c71c4	#6c71c4
shadow	rgba(0,0,0,0.55) rgba(0,0,0,0.12)	

Nord

Arctic, north-bluish clean and elegant. Source: <https://colorshexa.com/palette/nord-palette>

Token	Dark	Light
bgPrimary	#2e3440	#ecef f4
bgSecondary	#3b4252	#e5e9f0
bgTertiary	#434c5e	#d8dee9
border	#4c566a	#b8c0ce
textPrimary	#ecef f4	#2e3440
textSecondary	#d8dee9	#4c566a
accent	#88c0d0	#5e81ac
accentHover	#8fbcbb	#4c6e95
contrast	#ebcb8b	#d08770
success	#a3be8c	#5b8c3a
danger	#bf616a	#bf616a
warning	#ebcb8b	#b08900
info	#81a1c1	#81a1c1
purple	#b48ead	#b48ead
shadow	rgba(0,0,0,0.55)	rgba(0,0,0,0.12)

Monokai

Wimer Hazenberg's Monokai is the iconic Sublime Text palette. Source: <https://colorshexa.com/palette/monokai-palette>

Token	Dark	Light
bgPrimary	#272822	#fafaf5
bgSecondary	#383830	#ededeb
bgTertiary	#49483e	#dddbc f
border	#75715e	#b0ad9e
textPrimary	#f8f8f2	#272822
textSecondary	#cfcfc2	#75715e
accent	#f92672	#d63384
accentHover	#ff4890	#b5256e
contrast	#a6e22e	#689822
success	#a6e22e	#689822
danger	#f92672	#c02450
warning	#fd971f	#c6660a
info	#66d9ef	#2a9ab4
purple	#ae81ff	#7a4ddb
shadow	rgba(0,0,0,0.55)	rgba(0,0,0,0.12)

Gruvbox

Retro groove colour scheme is warm, earthy, high-contrast. Source: <https://colorshexa.com/palette/gruvbox-palette>

Token	Dark	Light
bgPrimary	#282828	#fbf1c7

Token	Dark	Light
bgSecondary	#3c3836	#ebdbb2
bgTertiary	#504945	#d5c4a1
border	#665c54	#bdae93
textPrimary	#ebdbb2	#3c3836
textSecondary	#a89984	#665c54
accent	#fb4934	#9d0006
accentHover	#cc241d	#79111e
contrast	#fabd2f	#b57614
success	#b8bb26	#79740e
danger	#fb4934	#9d0006
warning	#fabd2f	#b57614
info	#83a598	#076678
purple	#d3869b	#8f3f71
shadow	rgba(0,0,0,0.55)	rgba(0,0,0,0.12)

One Dark

Atom One Dark â€” balanced, signature editor palette. Source: <https://colorshexa.com/palette/one-dark-palette/>

Token	Dark	Light
bgPrimary	#282c34	#fafafa
bgSecondary	#353b45	#eaeaea
bgTertiary	#3e4451	#d3d3d5
border	#4b5263	#a0a1a7
textPrimary	#abb2bf	#383a42
textSecondary	#7f848e	#696c77
accent	#61afef	#4078f2
accentHover	#4e96d6	#2e62cc
contrast	#e5c07b	#986801
success	#98c379	#50a14f
danger	#e06c75	#e45649
warning	#e5c07b	#c18401
info	#56b6c2	#0184bc
purple	#c678dd	#a626a4
shadow	rgba(0,0,0,0.55)	rgba(0,0,0,0.12)

Tokyo Night

Clean, dark urban palette inspired by Tokyoâ€™s lights. Source: <https://colorshexa.com/palette/tokyo-night-palette/>

Token	Dark	Light
bgPrimary	#1a1b26	#e6e7ed
bgSecondary	#24283b	#d5d6db

Token	Dark	Light
bgTertiary	#2f344d	#c4c7d0
border	#414868	#989caf
textPrimary	#c0caf5	#343b58
textSecondary	#a9b1d6	#565a6e
accent	#7aa2f7	#34548a
accentHover	#6a91e6	#2a4471
contrast	#e0af68	#8f5e15
success	#9ece6a	#485e30
danger	#f7768e	#8c4351
warning	#e0af68	#8f5e15
info	#7dcfff	#2a6194
purple	#bb9af7	#5a3e8e
shadow	rgba(0,0,0,0.55) rgba(0,0,0,0.12)	

CSS variables

The 15 tokens surface as CSS custom properties on `<html>`. SCSS and component templates use these via `var(--color-*)`:

Token key	CSS variable
bgPrimary	--color-bg-primary
bgSecondary	--color-bg-secondary
bgTertiary	--color-bg-tertiary
border	--color-border
textPrimary	--color-text-primary
textSecondary	--color-text-secondary
accent	--color-accent
accentHover	--color-accent-hover
contrast	--color-contrast
success	--color-success
danger	--color-danger
warning	--color-warning
info	--color-info
purple	--color-purple
shadow	--color-shadow

`frontend/src/styles.scss` declares Darcula-dark fallbacks on `:root` so the page is styled even before ThemeService runs – no flash of unstyled content (FOUC) on first paint.

ThemeService API

Imported from `frontend/src/app/services/theme.service.ts`.

Member	Kind	Description
palette	Signal<Palette>	Current palette object (read-only).
mode	Signal<PaletteMode>	'light' or 'dark' (read-only).
currentTokens	Signal<PaletteTokens>	Active token set; switches with mode.
availablePalettes	readonly Palette[]	Full catalogue.
paletteIds	readonly string[]	Id list (convenience).
setPalette(id)	method	Switch to a palette. No-op for unknown ids.
setMode(mode)	method	Force light/dark. Marks the choice as sticky.
toggleMode()	method	Flip light ↔ dark.
isModeUserChosen()	method	true if user has explicitly chosen mode.

Storage key

```
// key: "qbit.theme"
{
  "paletteId": "darcula",
  "mode": "dark",
  "modeIsUserChosen": true
}
```

- When the store is empty, the service defaults to `DEFAULT_PALETTE_ID("darcula")` and derives mode from `window.matchMedia('(prefers-color-scheme: dark)')`.
- When the stored id no longer exists in the catalogue, the service falls back to the default AND writes the correction back to storage.
- While `modeIsUserChosen === false`, the service listens to `prefers-color-scheme` changes and updates mode to match. Once the user picks a mode explicitly (`setMode` / `toggleMode` / `picker`), the choice becomes sticky.

Side effects per change

On every `setPalette` / `setMode` / `toggleMode`, the service:

1. Writes every one of the 15 tokens to `document.documentElement.style.setProperty(--color-*, ...)`.
2. Sets `color-scheme` on the `documentElement` (for native UI controls).
3. Sets `data-palette` and `data-mode` attributes on `<html>`.
4. Persists the full state to `localStorage['qbit.theme']`.

These are observable, which is how the tests verify behaviour without false positives – see `frontend/src/app/services/theme.service.spec.ts` and `tests/e2e/test_theme_runtime.py`.

Theme picker UI

`frontend/src/app/components/theme-picker/` ships the corner widget used in the dashboard header. It is a standalone Angular component; any other app can drop `<app-theme-picker>` into its template. The picker renders:

- a light/dark mode toggle button,
- a dropdown listing every palette,
- four colour swatches per palette (accent, contrast, bg, text),
- an active-state marker (`.active + aria-checked="true"`) on the current palette.

Adding a new palette

1. Edit `frontend/src/app/models/palette.model.ts` and add an entry to `PALETTES`. Provide both `light` and `dark` variants with every one of the 15 tokens.
2. Make sure each token is a valid CSS colour (`#RRGGBB` or `rgba(r, g, b, a)`).
3. Run the catalogue parametric validator:

```
python3 -m pytest tests/unit/test_palette_catalog.py -v --no-cov
```

4. Run the wiring guard + frontend specs:

```
python3 -m pytest tests/unit/test_theme_wiring.py -v --no-cov  
npx --prefix frontend ng test --watch=false
```

5. Rebuild and restart the merge service (see CLAUDE.md's **REBUILD AND REBOOT** constraint). If Playwright is installed, run:

```
python3 -m pytest tests/e2e/test_theme_runtime.py -v --no-cov
```

The e2e test will loudly fail (not skip) when the served bundle does not include the new palette, which is the project's "no false positives" guarantee.

Files

- `frontend/src/app/models/palette.model.ts` "catalogue + types"
- `frontend/src/app/services/theme.service.ts` "runtime controller"
- `frontend/src/app/components/theme-picker/` "picker component"
- `frontend/src/styles.scss` "global CSS variable fallbacks"
- `frontend/src/app/components/dashboard/dashboard.component.scss` "dashboard stylesheet using `var(--color-*)`"
- `frontend/src/app/components/tracker-stat-dialog/tracker-stat-dialog.component.scss` "dialog stylesheet using `var(--color-*)`"
- `tests/unit/test_palette_catalog.py` "parametric catalogue validator"
- `tests/unit/test_theme_wiring.py` "wiring integration guard"
- `tests/e2e/test_theme_runtime.py` "Playwright runtime verification"